BISC x BlueLabs
2024 Elections Quantitative Analysis
December 2025

Key Takeaways

Ballot measures operate independently of top-of-ticket races.

- Across issues, voter coalitions supporting progressive-aligned ballot initiative positions often differed significantly from those supporting parties or candidates. Several progressive-aligned ballot initiative decisions even outperformed Democratic candidates at the top of the ticket, suggesting that voters were motivated by specific policies.
- In states with abortion-related measures on the ballot, voters in precincts with larger proportions of registered Republicans supported abortion access positions at rates 11-18 percentage points higher than they supported Harris, with over 1-in-3 voters in these areas supporting the pro-choice position across all states analyzed.
- Modeled analyses revealed that:
    - Across states, the voters most likely to split their ticket (supporting both Trump and pro-choice positions) tended to be white and either Independent or Republican.
    - In Colorado and Nebraska this pattern was driven by Independents, who were more likely than Republicans to back pro-choice positions.
    - Voters' pro-choice ballot measure support, even while voting for Trump, highlights that ballot measures operate beyond party lines to move issues with broad public support.

Progressive-aligned policies continue to resonate with voters.

- Paid sick leave, in particular, received broad support, winning easily in states where it was on the ballot.
    - For example, Nebraska's Initiative 436 won with 75% of the vote, exceeding Democratic performance, which sat at 40% of the vote.
        - Initiative 436 also outperformed Harris across all demographic groups. Nebraska saw the largest gaps in support for Initiative 436 and Harris in white, rural and exurban, and Republican precincts, garnering 61% support from voters living in Republican strongholds.
    - Missouri's Proposition A passed with 58% of the vote, exceeding top-of-ticket Democratic performance, which sat at 41% of the vote.

        - In fact, this measure outperformed Harris across all demographic groups. Voters in white precincts with fewer college degrees saw the most ticket splitting, voting in favor of Trump and Proposition A.

Coalitions and ballot measure outreach demands more depth.

- Key constituencies, such as Indigenous, Black, and other voters of color, tend to support these issues but are often under-invested in.
- Roll-off[1] across several issues in this analysis showcases a need for more intentional outreach, education, and communication with potential voters across the entire ballot.
    - **School Vouchers:** In Colorado, precincts with higher shares of demographics we'd expect to oppose school vouchers saw higher roll-off, including precincts with high levels of Black, Indigenous, and other voters of color who saw 5.6% roll-off.
    - **Abortion:** Precincts with high proportions of voters of color had amongst the highest roll-off in every state analyzed.
    - **Democracy:** Democracy-related measures saw the most roll-off in precincts with more voters of color, with Black precincts having higher than average roll-off rates.
    - **Criminal Legal Reform:** Precincts with high levels of voters of color and voters in urban areas in Arizona and the Los Angeles region showed the greatest support for reform but saw higher than average roll-off rates.
    - **Individual Rights (Right to Marry, Marijuana Legalization):** Despite being the strongest supporters of individual rights measures, precincts with high levels of Black voters saw some of the highest roll-off for these measures, alongside other voters of color.

Research Methodology

BISC partnered with BlueLabs to evaluate 23 key ballot initiatives from the 2024 cycle across Arizona, California, Colorado, Florida, Kentucky, Missouri, Nebraska, and Ohio. These measures spanned issues, including abortion, school funding, paid sick leave, democracy, criminal legal reform and individual rights. The results challenge some conventional views of the electorate and reinforce BISC's stance that ballot measures are transformational levers for long-term building, not just tools for short-term turnout.

BlueLabs collected and cleaned precinct data across these eight states. Separately, BlueLabs' data scientists modeled individual-level support for candidates and initiatives, adjusted to the 2024 election results. Then, results were analyzed by looking at the combined dataset augmented with key attributes from the voter file and Census data.

---

[1]Roll-off refers to the phenomenon where a voter votes on some contests on their ballot, while skipping others.

BISC Approach to Research

BISC's mission is to strengthen democracy by implementing a national progressive strategy for ballot measures rooted in building state-based power. We center the following principles when approaching our research program:

1. We conduct comprehensive research that includes quantitative and qualitative methodologies.
2. We collect data that gives us insight to a snapshot in time (like most traditional polling and focus groups) and we collect longitudinal data to give us insight over time through our Trendency panels.
3. We conduct research in the multi-modal ways that people access data, including text messaging, social media and online methodologies for gauging opinions.
4. We conduct research that allows for more complexity and nuance, utilizing scale - seeing participants as multi-dimensional, rather than binary beings.
5. We conduct research that helps us disrupt "monolith" narratives and strategies for BIPOC, immigrant and youth communities, to understand in more depth what is important to these traditionally underrepresented people -- the people we center in our long-term, movement building work.

Contact Us

For more information, including access to more comprehensive findings from individual states included in this analysis, or if you have any questions, please contact Adam Snipes, Director of Strategic Partnerships at adam@ballot.org.

DISCLAIMER: *Please be advised that the information contained herein is provided solely for educational purposes and is confidential and proprietary to the Ballot Initiative Strategy Center (BISC). This research report is intended for internal use within your organization or coalition and should not be shared publicly with audiences outside of your organization without prior written consent from BISC. Should this research report be disseminated to any third party, the originator hereby assumes full and absolute responsibility for any and all related reporting obligations, whether in-kind or otherwise.*

If the recipient of this research report is, or becomes, a registered committee under campaign finance laws, please be aware that receipt of this report during the committee's registration process may trigger reporting obligations related to in-kind contributions. We kindly request that recipients promptly notify Ballot Initiative Strategy Center (BISC) of their committee name upon registration with the appropriate state authorities.